

riivault — Reddit Data API Access Request

Non-commercial trend-research project · single niche · derived aggregates only · v0.1

1. WHAT THE PROJECT IS

riivault is a **non-commercial research project** that turns public discussion in one niche — SaaS / indie-hacker communities — into **derived time-series signals** (daily mention counts, sentiment trends, and normalized feature-request / pain-point themes). It publishes free public insight summaries. There is no paywall, no data resale, and no monetized product or service.

2. EXACTLY WHAT DATA WE READ

- **Endpoints:** subreddit listings (`/r/{sub}/new` , `/r/{sub}/hot`) and comment trees for matched threads, read-only, via OAuth script app.
- **Scope:** a fixed, small list of ~20 public subreddits — `r/SaaS`, `r/startups`, `r/Entrepreneur`, `r/indiehackers`, `r/microsaas`, `r/webdev`, `r/nocode`, and similar.
- **Frequency:** low-rate incremental polling with cursor-based dedup; strictly within the free tier limit of **100 QPM per OAuth client**, enforced by a token-bucket scheduler.
- No private data, no user DMs, no writes, no voting, no automated posting.

3. HOW WE HANDLE DATA (COMPLIANCE-FIRST)

Requirement	Our implementation
Raw content storage	Raw text held only in a temporary buffer with a ≤48h TTL , used solely for processing, then permanently deleted. Raw content is never a retained asset.
Deletion / removal honoring	When content is deleted or removed on Reddit, our raw copy is purged and any derived reference is invalidated. A deletion log tracks compliance.
What we retain	Only derived aggregates : daily mention counts, sentiment averages, and de-duplicated feature-request themes. No reconstructable raw archive.
AI / model training	Reddit content is never used as training input for any model.
Redistribution	No raw Reddit content is redistributed. Only aggregate, non-identifying statistics are shown publicly.

4. WHY THE DEVELOPER PLATFORM (DEVVIT) DOES NOT FIT

riivault monitors ~20 public subreddits that we do **not** moderate. Devvit apps are installed per-subreddit by that community's own moderators and are scoped to subreddits the developer moderates, so they structurally cannot observe communities we do not run. riivault also stores derived time-series data in an external database (Postgres/TimescaleDB + pgvector) and publishes insights on an off-Reddit public website and newsletter. Devvit's in-Reddit app model — Reddit-hosted Redis/KV storage, rendering inside the platform — supports none of these. The Data API is the only viable path for this read-only, non-commercial use case.

5. COMMERCIAL STATUS

Non-commercial. No monetization, no business entity operating this, no product sold. Output is free public insight. Should this ever change, we understand a separate commercial agreement would be required and would request it before any commercial use.

6. TECHNICAL SUMMARY

- App type: **script** (personal, read-only).
- Auth: OAuth2 client credentials; unique descriptive User-Agent in the required `<platform>:<app-id>:<version>` (by `/u/username`) format.
- Storage split: transient raw buffer ($\leq 48h$) vs. permanent derived aggregates — enforced in code.

Prepared for Reddit Data Access Request review. Contact and Reddit username provided in the ticket. This document describes actual implemented behavior, not intent.